

Retouch Images

10



Absolutely.

Oh, you know, you can remove any unwanted objects from an image very easily.

Look Dad, Mom taught me how to fix colours in a picture. Doesn't this image look amazing?

I wish I had an image of the Ship of the Dessert. All the pictures have people around.



We use devices like smartphones or digital cameras to take pictures. The photos are automatically stored on the device we use. Sometimes, the images don't turn out the way we want them. In this case, we can use an image editor to enhance or correct them.

We have already learnt two techniques to edit images: crop and colour correction.

In this lesson, we will learn a technique to remove image defects or unwanted elements.

Photo retouching

Photo retouching refers to making small changes in the image to improve the appearance of the image. It is a process to perform specific area adjustments of an image after performing overall adjustments like colour correction. Retouching can be used to remove a variety of image defects, for example, dust or dirt on a lens or unwanted objects in the image.

For example:

- We can remove the parachute in front of the snow clad mountain.



Before retouch



After retouch

Activity

Here is an image of Al Jahili fort with some tourists who visit it for its beauty. Let's learn how to clean the image and remove the people to view only the camel.

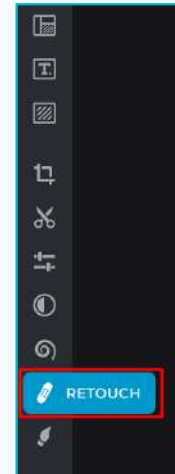


Before retouch

After retouch

Activity

To clean up or remove unwanted elements from images in **Pixlr**, we use the **Retouch** tool.



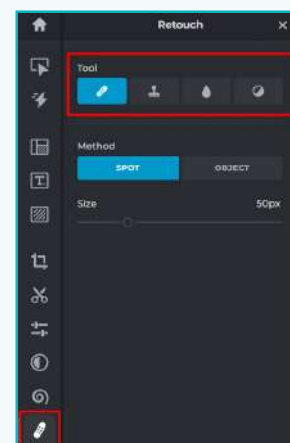
Retouch has multiple tools. Let's explore them and learn how to improve the appearance of our image.

- 1 Open the picture in an image editor. We will use Pixlr.



- 2 Select the Retouch tool to explore its options.

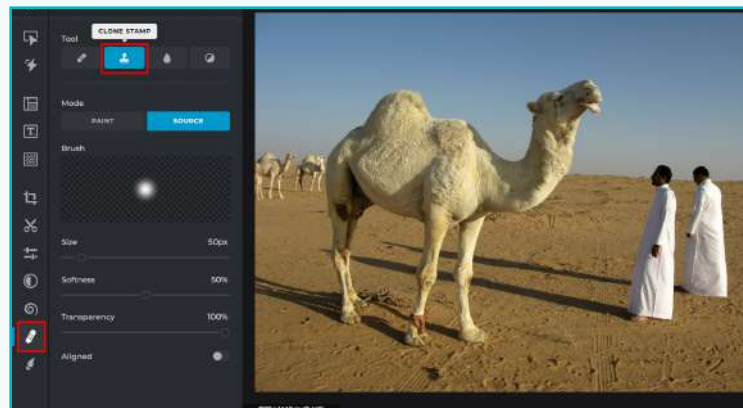
a. Here we can see the different retouch tools.



Activity

1. Clone stamp: Clone stamp is a prime tool for photo retouching. This tool lets us fill, remove, or replace certain areas with a sample of another area in the image. It replaces the target area with a manually selected source sample.

b. Select the Clone tool.



c. Identify a part that needs to be corrected and a part which can be cloned.



d. Set the **mode** to **source**.

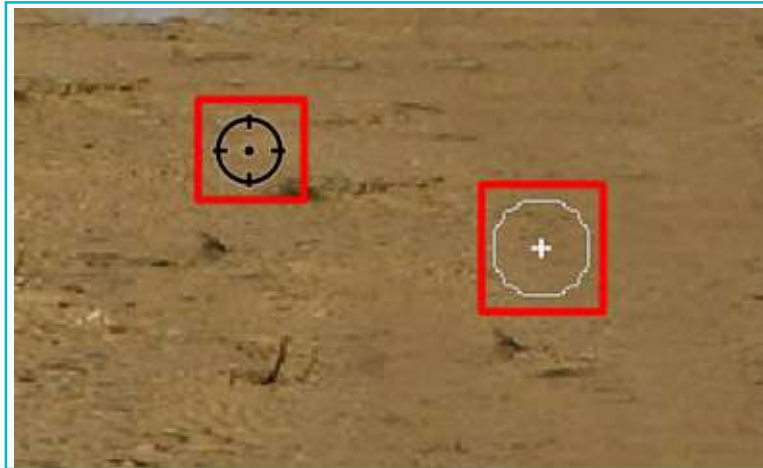
Source is the area we want to clone or copy. **Target** is the unwanted area that we want to replace with the source area.

e. Click once on the source area to set the source.

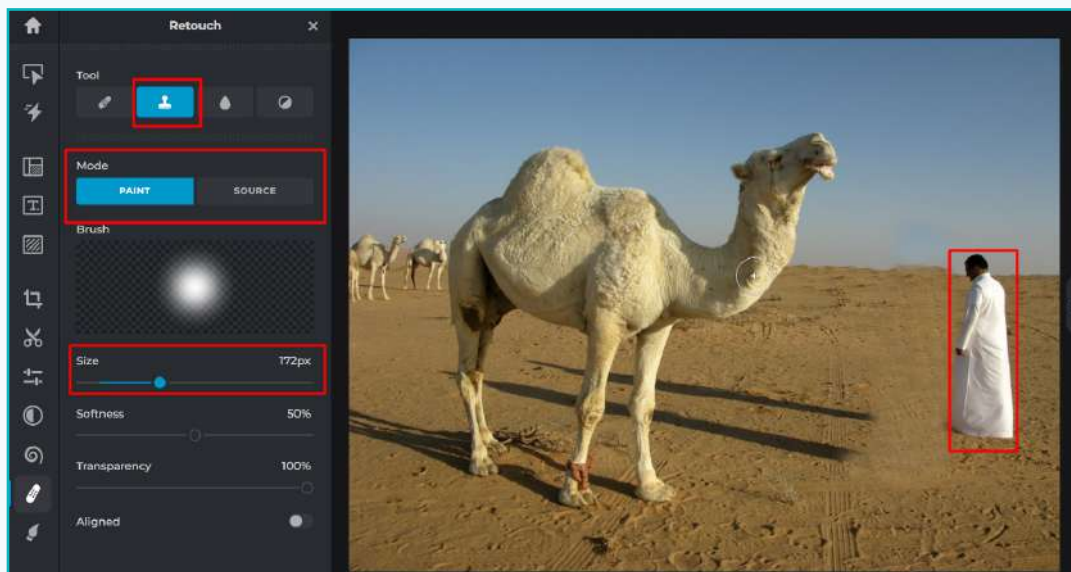
f. Once the source is set, the mode will change to paint.

Activity

g. Paint the target area to remove unwanted elements.



h. Re-sample another source and clone different areas to replace other unwanted elements.



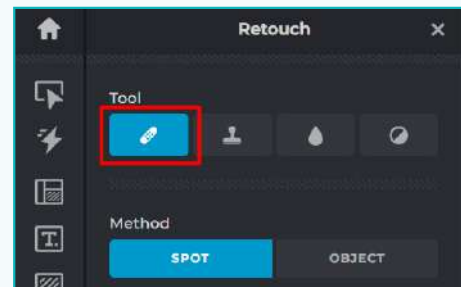
Note:

- When the clone stamp tool is selected, hold the shift key and click to select the source.
- Change the brush size to clone stamp smaller areas.

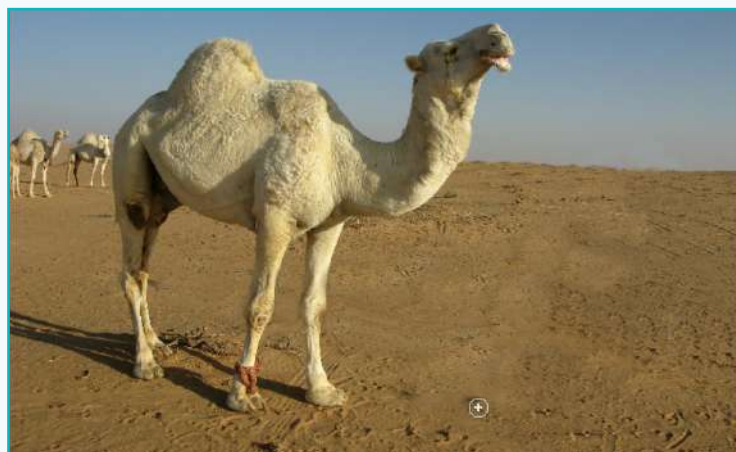
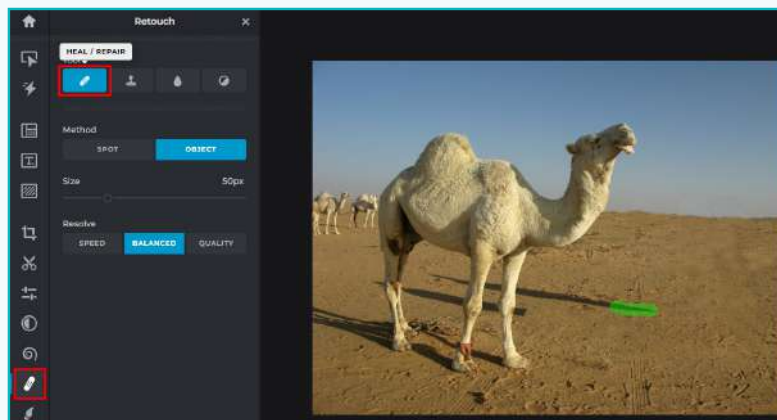
Activity

2. Heal/repair tool: This is another useful tool for image retouching. In case of the clone stamp tool, the source sample has to be manually selected. The Heal/repair tool automatically selects the source sample.

a. Select the **Heal/repair tool**.



b. Set a suitable brush size. Dab on the area that needs to be corrected until it is clean.
You can use it to clear the shadows of people.



Using clone and heal/repair tools retouch the image

Activity

3. Save the image

a. Save the retouched image in .png format.



Retouching can also be used to restore an old photo.

Before digital devices were invented, analogue cameras were used to take photographs. The cameras had a reel which would store an image of the photograph. Once it was printed, we could see the final photograph. These cameras did not store a digital copy of the photo in their device memory.

Reels and printed photographs tend to get damaged over time. This could be due to a variety of reasons. They could:

- get torn in parts
- have fold marks on the paper
- get damaged due to moisture, heat, pollutants, or carelessness
- have faded ink
- get lines and scratches
- lose colour

These photos can be easily restored with a photo editing software.



Before retouch

After retouch

Retouching improves the appearance of an image or corrects a damaged photograph. Retouching enhancements can make photos look cleaner and more attractive. We can even remove scratches, match colours, recreate damaged parts of an old photo and make them appear new. Tools like clone stamp, heal/repair, etc. are used in photo editing software.

Exercise

Fill in the blanks

- 1 _____ refers to making small changes in the image to improve its appearance.
- 2 Clone stamp tool allows to _____, _____, or _____ certain areas with samples of other areas.
- 3 A manual sample is required for the _____ tool.
- 4 _____ tool functions like the clone stamp tool, but with automatic source selection.

10. Retouch Images



Tech Flash

- **Photo retouch** : A process to make minor changes in the image to improve the appearance of the image.
- **Clone stamp** : It replaces the target area, with a manually selected source.
- **Heal/Repair** : It replaces the target area with an automatically selected source.